

Left, which has made its stance, of not supporting the Indo-US nuclear deal, clear a number of times. The Congress should have, instead, spent this time trying to bring the BJP on board.

BISHAN SAHAI, on e-mail

Dawdling is the only word that can describe the talks between Left and the UPA on the nuclear deal. Manmohan Singh has to take a call on the issue if he does not want history to view him as a weak prime minister.

MEGHA A., Hyderabad

It is high time that the prime minister listened to his inner voice and went ahead with the deal, which would change the course of history. He should not succumb to the pressure tactics of the Left or the BJP.

DILBAG RAI, Chandigarh

Casting Mess

Kirori Singh Bainsla's triumph through terror has proved that it is essential to adopt anti-national means to become a national hero ("Salute to Success", June 30).

RAJNEESH BATRA, Delhi

Water God

Among my pet peeves are Pakistan, politicians, policemen and priests ("Worshipping Every Drop", June 30). But after reading your story, one of them redeemed themselves in my eyes. Why Purushottam Gaur impressed me even more was the fact that he was able to bring around the politicians.

SUSHIL GUPTA, Delhi

The government agencies must take cue from Gaur's unique idea to bind environment conservation with religion. After all, even the Hindu mythology says that the river Ganga originates from Lord Shiva's head, and perhaps, it is Lord Shiva who will solve the problem of water crisis.

PRAVEEN SINGH RATHORE, on e-mail

No Child's Play

Till now, it was the poor families which compelled

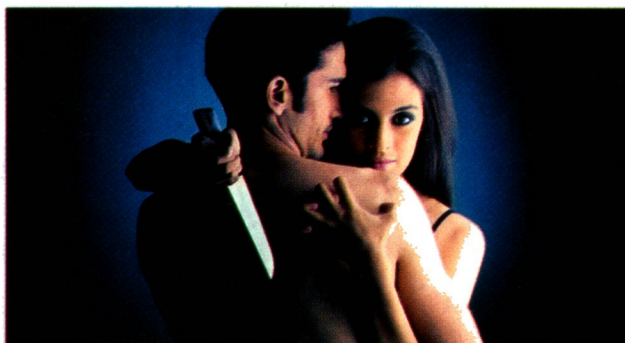
their children to work to avoid starvation ("No Time for Innocence", June 30). However, it is ironical to see even the well-to-do families do the same to earn fame and extra money.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

Correction

In "The Big Thirst" (June 30), it had erroneously been mentioned that the water became turgid, instead of turbid. The error is regretted.

MIND THE MORALS



While it is true that passion led to most of the crimes mentioned in the story, one cannot help pointing out other major reasons—parental neglect, damaging influence of the electronic media and cinema, break-up of joint families along with the lack of moral education in schools ("Crimes of Passion", June 23).

G.M. RAMA RAO, Visakhapatnam

I agree with Kalpana Lajmi's views that channelising women's power will help stabilise the deteriorating Indian social structure. But it was surprising to see Ekta Kapoor speak about the "rising" of Indian women when her serials portray just the opposite.

DEVASHRI DUTTA, on e-mail

The article reflects the dangerous fallouts of aping the Western world. The rat race for acquiring money and fame is forcing people to look for pleasure outside the boundaries of their own world.

ARCHANA NEGLI, on e-mail

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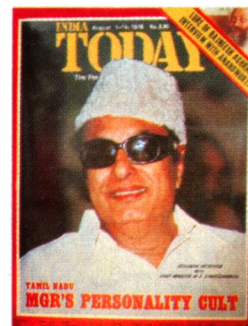
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Years Ago in India Today

AUGUST 1-15, 1978



A Cathartic Experience

That brief but emotive piece of futuristic hyperbole sums up the Rajneesh "message"—a message that is being increasingly listened to and accepted by an estimated 80,000 followers. Today, Bhagwan Sree Rajneesh is one of India's most saleable gurus. His popularity, particularly in the US and western Europe, is rivalled perhaps only by Swami Mukhtananda. In India, he commands an ever-increasing audience.

Controversy is his middle name. He is denounced as a voyeur by some and hailed as the next Buddha by others. And his modern Rs 2-crore, 6-acre ashram in Pune is fast becoming a sanctum for people with a taste for his particular brand of counter-culture spiritualism. All that could change now. According to ashram sources, Bhagwan's opponents "have recently launched a concerted campaign against him."

—Minhaz Merchant

